

COMPREHENSIVE HUMAN RESOURCES POLICY

Standard Operating Procedures & Employee Guidelines | v.2026.1

1. Introduction & Overview

This Employee Handbook ("Handbook") is designed to acquaint you with Acme Corporation and provide you with information about working conditions, employee benefits, and some of the policies affecting your employment. It describes many of your responsibilities as an employee and outlines the programs developed by the Company to benefit employees.

At-Will Employment: Employment at Acme Corporation is on an "at-will" basis, meaning that either you or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, for any reason, with or without cause, and with or without notice. Nothing in this Handbook is intended to or does create an employment contract, express or implied.

2. Equal Employment Opportunity

2.1 EEO Policy

The Company is an equal opportunity employer. We will extend equal opportunity to all individuals without regard to race, religion, color, sex (including pregnancy, sexual orientation and gender identity), national origin, disability, age, genetic information, or any other status protected under applicable federal, state, or local laws. Our policy reflects and affirms the Company's commitment to the principles of fair employment and the elimination of all discriminatory practices.

2.2 Anti-Harassment

We are committed to providing a work environment free of sexual or any form of unlawful harassment or discrimination. Harassment based on any protected characteristic is strictly prohibited. This policy applies to all persons involved in the operations of the Company and prohibits unlawful harassment by any employee, including supervisors and co-workers.

Reporting Procedure: Any employee who believes they have been harassed must immediately report the incident to their supervisor or the Human Resources Director. All complaints will be investigated promptly and confidentially.

3. Employment Categories

It is the intent of the Company to clarify the definitions of employment classifications so that employees understand their employment status and benefit eligibility.

- **Regular Full-Time:** Employees who are regularly scheduled to work 40 or more hours per week. Eligible for the Company's full benefits package.
- **Regular Part-Time:** Employees who are regularly scheduled to work less than 30 hours per week. Part-time employees may be eligible for some benefits subject to the terms of specific benefit plans.
- **Temporary/Contract:** Employees hired as interim replacements, to temporarily supplement the work force, or to assist in the completion of a specific project.

Exempt vs. Non-Exempt

Employees are categorized as either "Exempt" or "Non-Exempt" in accordance with federal and state wage and hour laws. Non-exempt employees are entitled to overtime pay, whereas exempt employees (typically executive, administrative, or professional staff) are excluded from specific provisions of federal and state wage and hour laws.

4. Workplace Conduct

4.1 Code of Ethics

Employees are expected to act with honesty, integrity, and professionalism at all times. Conflicts of interest, whether actual or perceived, must be disclosed to management. Employees must not use

their position for personal gain or accept improper gifts from vendors or clients.

4.2 Attendance and Punctuality

To maintain a safe and productive work environment, the Company expects employees to be reliable and to be punctual in reporting for scheduled work. Absenteeism and tardiness place a burden on other employees and on the Company. In the rare instances when employees cannot avoid being late or are unable to work as scheduled, they should notify their supervisor as soon as possible in advance of the anticipated tardiness or absence.

4.3 Dress Code

Employees are expected to present a clean, neat, and professional appearance. Dress code requirements will vary depending on the employee's department and degree of public contact. Generally, "Business Casual" is the standard for office workers.

4.4 Technology & Internet Usage

Company-provided equipment, including computers, internet access, and email, is intended for business purposes. While limited personal use is permitted, it must not interfere with productivity. The Company reserves the right to monitor all communications and internet usage on its systems. Downloading unauthorized software or engaging in illegal online activities is strictly prohibited and grounds for immediate termination.

5. Compensation & Payroll

5.1 Pay Periods

All employees are paid bi-weekly on every other Friday. Each paycheck will include earnings for all work performed through the end of the previous payroll period. If a regular payday falls during a company holiday, employees will be paid on the last business day prior to the holiday.

5.2 Overtime

When operating requirements or other needs cannot be met during regular working hours, employees may be scheduled to work overtime hours. When possible, advance notification of these mandatory assignments will be provided. All overtime work must receive the supervisor's prior authorization. Overtime compensation is paid to all non-exempt employees in accordance with federal and state wage and hour restrictions (typically 1.5 times the

regular rate for hours worked beyond 40 in a workweek).

6. Benefits & Time Off

6.1 Paid Time Off (PTO)

The Company provides PTO to eligible employees to enable them to take time off for rest, recreation, illness, or personal matters. PTO accrual begins upon hire but cannot be utilized until the completion of a 90-day probationary period.

Years of Service	Annual PTO Accrual	Max Carryover
0 - 2 Years	15 Days (120 hours)	5 Days
3 - 5 Years	20 Days (160 hours)	5 Days
6+ Years	25 Days (200 hours)	10 Days

6.2 Holidays

The Company observes the following paid holidays for full-time employees: New Year's Day, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day, Day after Thanksgiving, and Christmas Day.

6.3 Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA)

Employees who have been employed for at least one year, and for at least 1,250 hours during the preceding 12-month period, are eligible for up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave for specific family and medical reasons, in accordance with the FMLA.

6.4 Bereavement Leave

In the event of the death of an immediate family member, regular full-time employees may take up to three (3) consecutive days of paid bereavement leave.

7. Performance & Discipline

7.1 Performance Reviews

Supervisors and employees are strongly encouraged to discuss job performance and goals on an informal, day-to-day basis. Formal performance evaluations are conducted annually to provide both supervisors and employees the opportunity to discuss job tasks, identify and correct weaknesses, encourage and recognize strengths, and discuss positive, purposeful approaches for meeting goals.

7.2 Progressive Discipline

The Company generally supports the use of progressive discipline to address issues such as poor work performance or misconduct. Our progressive discipline policy may include verbal warnings, written warnings, suspension with or without pay, and finally, termination. However, the Company reserves the right to administer discipline in any manner it sees fit, bypassing steps if the severity of the offense warrants immediate termination (e.g., theft, violence, severe harassment).

8. Separation of Employment

8.1 Resignation

Resignation is a voluntary act initiated by the employee to terminate employment with the Company. Although advance notice is not required, the Company requests at least two weeks' written resignation notice from all employees.

8.2 Return of Company Property

Employees are responsible for all Company property, materials, or written information issued to them or in their possession or control. All Company property must be returned on or before the employee's last day of work. Where permitted by applicable laws, the Company may withhold from the employee's check or final paycheck the cost of any items that are not returned.

Acknowledgment: By accepting employment, employees acknowledge they have read, understand, and agree to abide by the policies and procedures set forth in this handbook. The Company reserves the right to revise, modify, delete, or add to any and all policies, procedures, work rules, or benefits stated in this handbook at any time, except for the policy of at-will employment.